

May

24

2018 Cat-free zone

The world's longest cat-proof fence was completed at Newhaven Wildlife Sanctuary, Australia. Measuring 44 km (27 miles) long, it protects native birds and marsupials, such as the rufous hare-wallaby, from wild cats.



Born this day

1686 Daniel Gabriel Fahrenheit, Polish-born physicist. He invented the first widely used thermometer and devised the Fahrenheit temperature scale used in the USA today.

Also on this day

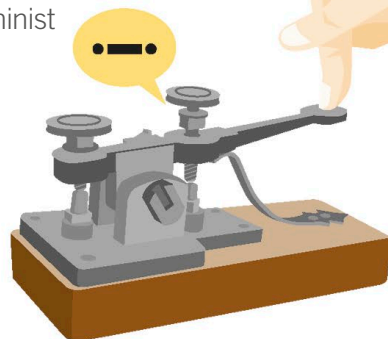
1798 Inspired by similar uprisings in France and the USA, an Irish rebellion was a major landmark in the country's long struggle for independence from British rule.

1822 The Battle of Pichincha took place on the slopes of the Pichincha volcano in present-day Ecuador, bringing victory for South American rebels and ending Spanish rule.

1956 The first Eurovision Song Contest was staged in Lugano, Switzerland, with seven countries taking part.

1844 Morse code

US inventor Samuel Morse and machinist Alfred Vail sent the first message by telegraph, from Washington, DC, to Baltimore, USA. The message "What hath God wrought?" was coded with dots and dashes.



1883 Mega bridge

The opening of the Brooklyn Bridge in New York City, USA, was celebrated with fireworks and a musical performance. The world's longest suspension bridge at the time, it connected the boroughs of Manhattan and Brooklyn.

